

A *parameter* is information the function needs to do its work. An *argument* is a value passed to a function.

To define parameters for a function, place them within the parentheses in the function's definition. This creates a `hello()` function that requires name data:

```
def hello(name):  
    """Greet someone by name."""  
    print(f"Hello, {name}!")
```

To run, this function needs a name argument, which it stores in the name variable and uses when it calls `print()`.

Pass an argument to a function by including a value in the parentheses when you call the function:

```
hello("Gretchen")
```

The argument provides a value for the parameter name, allowing the `hello()` function to generate a personalized greeting:

```
Hello, Gretchen!
```

Sometimes *parameter* and *argument* are used interchangeably.